Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/jameswilliamcarlson (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Leadership
Operational Planning
Project Management

Publications

LawProp: Using Quotations to Identify Legal Propositions in Judicial Opinions

Jim Carlson

Founder & Product Leader | AI & Defense Technology | Marine Corps & Stanford Alum
San Diego Metropolitan Area

Summary

Experienced product executive and entrepreneur building the next generation of AI-native enterprise software for defense manufacturing. With 20+ years leading high-stakes initiatives across AI product development, defense technology, and startup environments, I'm passionate about solving the operational challenges that constrain innovation in critical industries.

Most recently served as Chief Legal and Information Officer at Shield AI. Previously led product and program management at Shield AI, overseeing development of AI-powered autonomous systems. Founded and led DFL Technology as Founder/CTO until its successful acquisition by Reveal Technology, developing and shipping an innovative AI-powered tactical biometric system to U.S. Special Operations Command.

Retired Marine Corps veteran with combat experience as an attack helicopter pilot across multiple deployments to Iraq and Afghanistan. Developed and fielded the "Combat iPad" in Afghanistan. Stanford-educated (JD/MBA) with deep expertise in defense technology, AI product development, and scaling startups in regulated environments.

Experience

Ironflow AI
Co-Founder
May 2025 - Present (1 year 2 months)
San Diego, CA

Building AI-native enterprise software to solve critical operational challenges in defense manufacturing.

Shield AI
Chief Legal and Information Officer

March 2023 - May 2025 (2 years 3 months)
San Diego, California, United States

United States Marine Corps
Founding Director, Innovation Laboratory at Marine Innovation Unit
September 2021 - October 2024 (3 years 2 months)

DFL Technology
Founder / CTO (acquired by Reveal Technology)
May 2021 - April 2023 (2 years)
San Diego, CA

Shield AI
Director of Product Management
April 2018 - August 2021 (3 years 5 months)
San Diego, California, United States

BitRip
Product
January 2020 - December 2020 (1 year)

United States Marine Corps
Director of Air Operations at Force Reconnaissance Company
October 2014 - May 2017 (2 years 8 months)
Alameda, California, United States

McKinsey & Company
Summer Associate
June 2016 - August 2016 (3 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

United States Marine Corps
10 years 11 months

Director of Operations at Special Operations Training Group
May 2011 - August 2014 (3 years 4 months)
Camp Pendleton, California

Attack Helicopter Commander and Weapons and Tactics Instructor
May 2006 - April 2011 (5 years)
Camp Pendleton, California

Officer and Student Pilot
October 2003 - April 2006 (2 years 7 months)

Cyberbranch (acquired by CGI)
Software Engineer
January 2000 - September 2002 (2 years 9 months)
Palo Alto, California, United States

Education

Stanford University Graduate School of Business
Master of Business Administration (M.B.A.) · (2014 - 2017)

Stanford Law School
Juris Doctor (J.D.) · (2014 - 2017)

Stanford University
Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Philosophy Major, Computer Science Minor